

Start Here: Set Your Weights and Syllabus

MJ World History: Dawn of Civilization to Roman Empire · Florida course 2109010 · Grade 6

Read this before the term starts. Two things in this course are deliberately left for you to set: the assignment group weights in Canvas, and the grading section of the syllabus you hand to families. They do not currently agree with each other, and they cannot be reconciled centrally: this course is taught in both Live and On-Demand sections by several different teachers, each setting their own weights and pacing. Reconciling them for your section is your job, and it takes about ten minutes.

Step one

Set your grade weights in Canvas

The course ships live with five weighted assignment groups. Confirm these or change them before you publish anything. In Canvas go to **Assignments**, open the  menu at the top right, and choose **Assignment Group Weight**.

Assignment group	Group ID	Ships at	What lives here
Tier 1: Reading Quizzes	272	21%	Both weekly Reading Quizzes (Monday and Wednesday), auto-graded, for all 18 weeks.
Tier 2: Weekly Discussions and Course Reflection	293	15%	The six weekly Discussions (Weeks 2, 4, 9, 11, 13, 16) plus the optional Course Reflection discussion.
Tier 3: Deep Feedback	294	34%	All 36 weekly Critical Questions and Primary Source Exercises, the 6 required VR Activities (Weeks 6, 7, 8, 12, 15, 18), the Appendices Primary Source Exercise, and the optional Comparative Essay.
Tier 4: Module Check-Ins (Ungraded)	295	0%	Module intro and outro wrapper quizzes, plus every supplemental VR activity.
Quarterly Exams	427	30%	Quarter 1 Exam and Quarter 2 Exam only.

Step two

2 Then edit your syllabus to match

The syllabus masters in this module state a different scheme: **50%** asynchronous homework, **30%** projects, **20%** synchronous homework and activities. That will not match whatever you set in Step 1, and it was never meant to; the syllabi were written independently of the live Canvas gradebook.

1. Decide which syllabus your section needs: On-Demand or Live (see Step 3).
2. Download the `.odt` or `.docx` for that version from this module.
3. Correct the **Assessment and Grading** section so it states the weights you actually set in Step 1.
4. Add your name, email, and office hours in the header block.
5. Reupload your edited copy to this course, and let your course lead know so the syllabus families see in Canvas is refreshed.

Do not simply average or split the difference between the two numbers. The syllabus percentages and the Canvas group weights are answering two different questions asked at two different times. Pick the Canvas weights in Step 1 first, as the deployed default, then write the syllabus to describe whatever you actually chose.

Step three

3 Pick which syllabus you need

Two versions ship in this module: **On-Demand (asynchronous)** and **Live (synchronous)**. They cover the same content and expectations, but the On-Demand version describes self-paced work within each quarter, and the Live version describes a section that meets on a schedule. Download the `.docx` for the one matching your section, fill in your own details, and reupload it. Leave the other version's file alone; a colleague teaching the other format needs it untouched.

Step four

4 Know what is optional

The **Course Review (Optional)** module, at the end of Quarter 2, does not count toward a student's grade. Its three graded-shaped parts, the Tier 1 Quiz, the Tier 2 Discussion, and the Tier 3 Comparative Essay, all carry `omit_from_final_grade` in Canvas. Points are still visible and students can still submit for feedback, but nothing there moves the gradebook.

Thirty supplemental VR activities ship unpublished inside Tier 4, at 0 points. They are not required. Publish and assign any you want your students to do. The 6 required VR Activities (Weeks 6, 7, 8, 12, 15, 18) already live in Tier 3 and need no action from you.

Step five

5 Know what is unfinished

Both syllabi carry two placeholder rows for Quarter 3 and Quarter 4, marked `[Spring topic - to be finalized]` with `TBD` target dates. That is accurate. This build covers Weeks 1 through 18 (Quarters 1 and 2) only. **Weeks 19 through 36 (the Spring semester, Quarters 3 and 4) are not yet built.** Do not remove or fill in those rows yourself; the Spring build is a separate, later effort planned on its own schedule.

Everything else

A **Teacher Manual (Facilitator Copy)** is planned for this module but is not yet built. When it is added, it will cover how the course runs day to day: the assessment catalog and how to grade each type, the rubrics and their Canvas IDs, the workload map, standards coverage, and any documented exceptions. Check back once your course lead has added it.

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